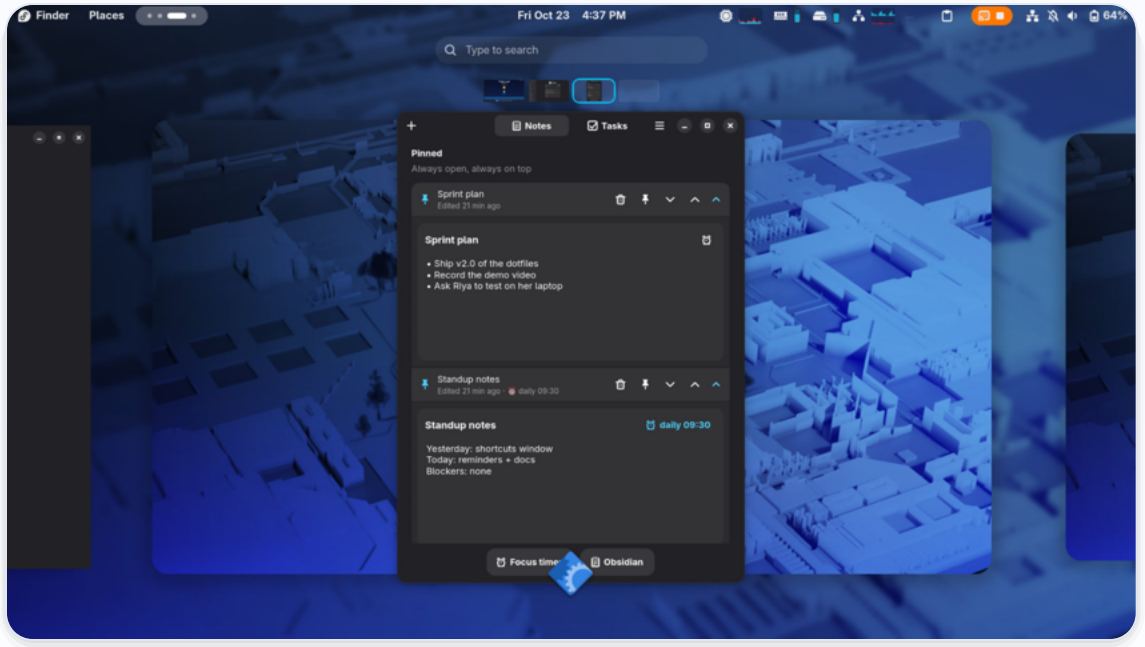
MK Workstation

Fedora, made for getting things done.

One command turns a fresh Fedora Workstation into a fast, familiar and productive desktop: Windows and macOS habits, notes and reminders, face unlock, and settings that adapt to your hardware.

Fedora 44 **GNOME 50 · Wayland** **Open source**



The overview on an HP ENVY x360 13 running MK Workstation

THE STARTING POINT

Stock Fedora Workstation

A clean, fast, secure Linux from the Fedora Project, backed by Red Hat. It ships the newest GNOME exactly as its designers intended, with very little added.

- **Strong foundation** SELinux, Wayland, Btrfs, automatic security updates, new release every 6 months.
- **Pure GNOME** One focused way of working: Activities overview, keyboard first, few settings.
- **Free software only** Patented codecs and hardware video decoding are left out by policy.

What people notice in the first hour

- **No dock or tray icons** apps live in the overview only
- **No minimize button** and no Windows-style snapping or layouts
- **Alt+Tab per workspace** windows elsewhere are hidden
- **Videos use the CPU** H.264 / HEVC decoding isn't hardware-accelerated
- **Everything by hand** apps, extensions, shortcuts, codecs, drivers, one by one
- **No notes, tasks or reminders** beyond separate apps

WHAT IT ADDS

Six things, one command

One command
sudo ./setup.sh installs codecs, drivers, 60+ apps, extensions and settings. Safe to run again; backs up what it touches.

Feels familiar
Dock, snap layouts, Alt+Tab across workspaces, macOS gestures and shortcuts, Windows keys like Super+E and Ctrl+Shift+Esc.

Productivity built in
Notes, tasks and reminders, a focus timer, OCR, clipboard history and a live shortcuts window.

Face and fingerprint
Log in by looking at the camera or touching the reader; both set up for the hardware you have.

Smart for your device
Power profiles follow the charger, effects scale to the hardware, GPU video decoding is set up for your graphics.

Yours to change
Every shortcut, app and name lives in plain text files. Rename it, rebind it, fork it.

SIDE BY SIDE

Stock Fedora vs MK Workstation

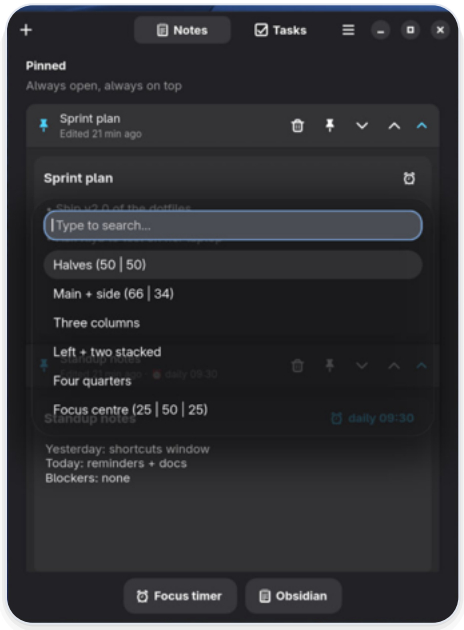
	STOCK FEDORA	WITH MK WORKSTATION
Setup	Install apps, codecs and extensions by hand	One command, then mk update keeps it all current
Video	Software decoding for H.264 / HEVC	Full codecs + GPU decoding for your graphics card
Windows	Maximize and half-screen tiling	Snap layouts (Super+Z), quarters, always on top
Switching	Alt+Tab shows the current workspace	Alt+Tab shows everything, 3- and 4-finger gestures
Dock	Only inside the overview	Auto-hiding dock with app-coloured hover
Notes & tasks	Separate apps	Companion: pinned notes, tasks, reminders, morning brief
Shortcuts	Scattered across Settings	One window: status of each, change or reset in a click
Battery	Profile stays where you left it	Performance on AC, balanced on battery, saver when low
Login	Password	Face unlock and fingerprint, detected and set up for you
Health	—	mk doctor checks codecs, GPU, extensions, clashes, updates
Sound	Thin laptop speakers	B&O-style speaker tuning: EQ, bass, limiter (mk sound)

DESKTOP AND MULTITASKING

Windows habits, macOS feel, GNOME underneath



Alt+Tab: every window on every workspace, with live previews

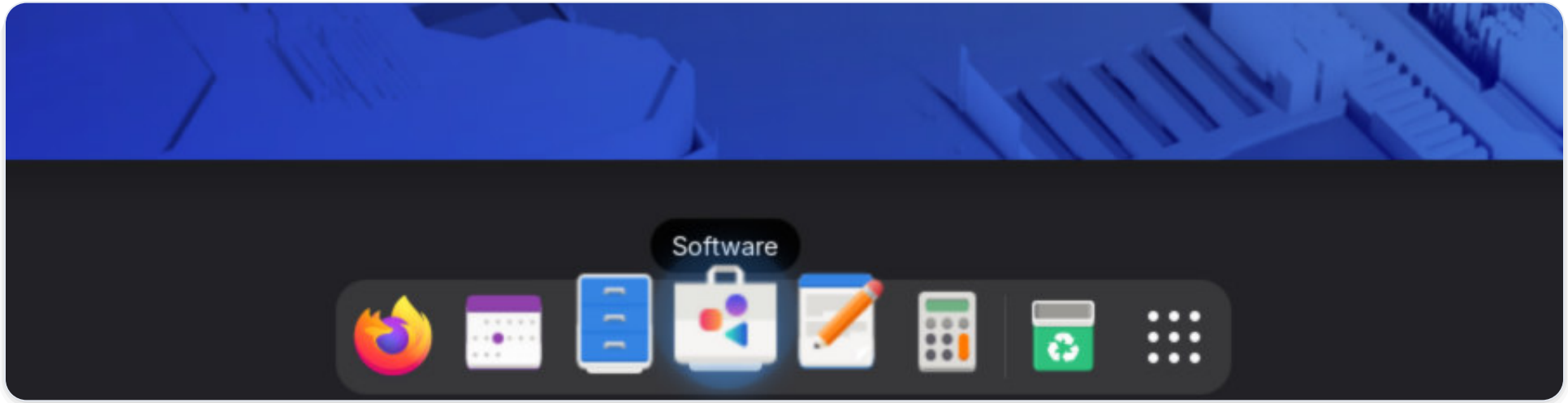


Super+Z: snap layouts

- **Gestures** 4 fingers ←/→ workspace, 3 fingers ←/→ window, 3 up overview
- **Snap** Super+arrows halves and quarters, Snap Assist
- **Spaces** Super+Ctrl+D new desktop, Super+Ctrl+←/→ move
- **Polish** genie minimize, soft open/close, 25% faster animations

THE DOCK

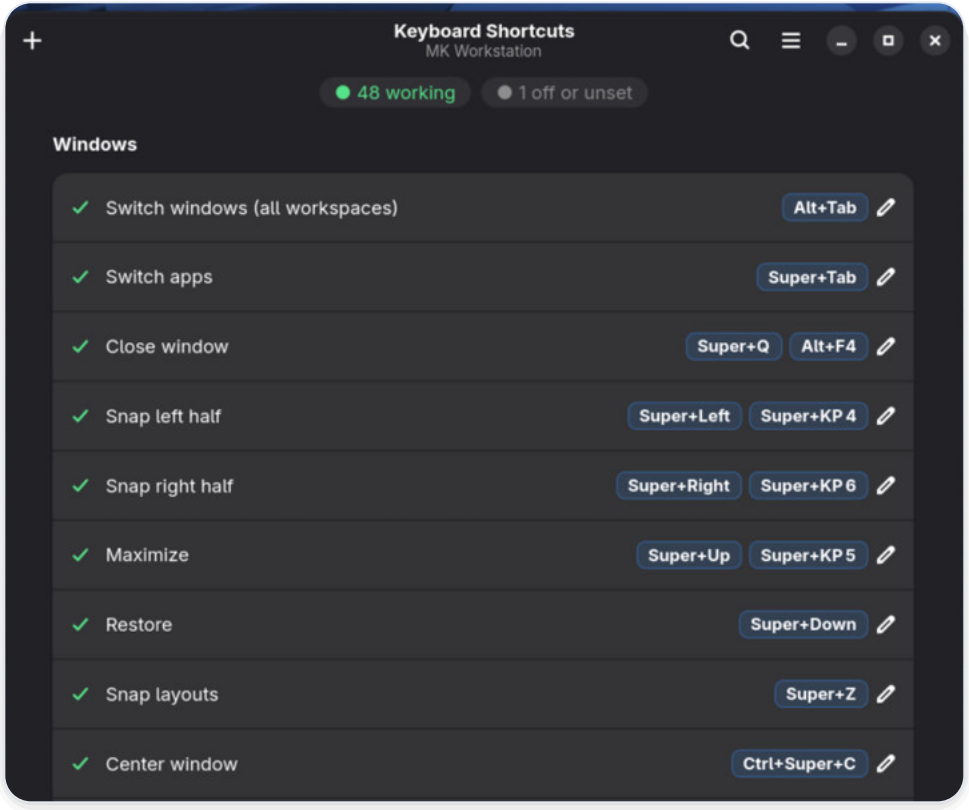
A dock that feels alive, and stays out of the way



- **Magnification** the icon under the pointer grows and its neighbours follow in a soft wave, like macOS
- **App-coloured glow** a subtle circular tint in each app's own colour: Spotify green, Obsidian purple
- **Out of the way** hides when a window touches it and steps aside in the overview
- **Taskbar clicks** click to focus or minimize, thumbnails for apps with several windows, middle-click for a new one
- **Tunable** size, spread and speed in config/dock.conf; MAGNIFY=1 turns it off

SUPER + /

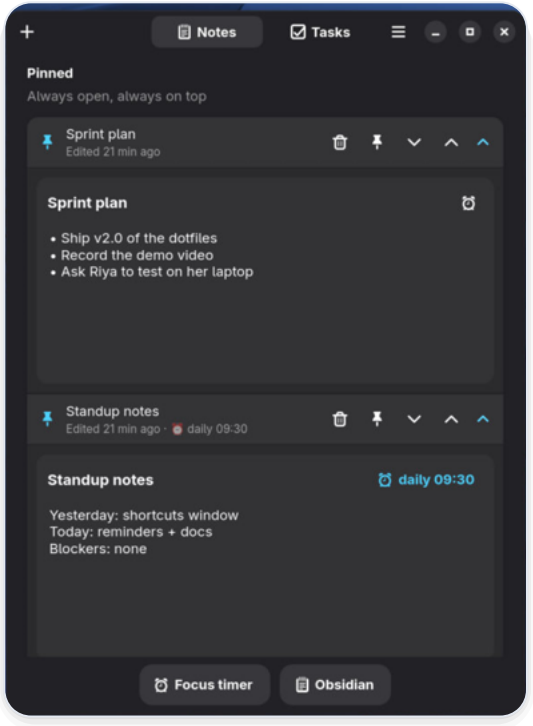
Every shortcut, in one live window

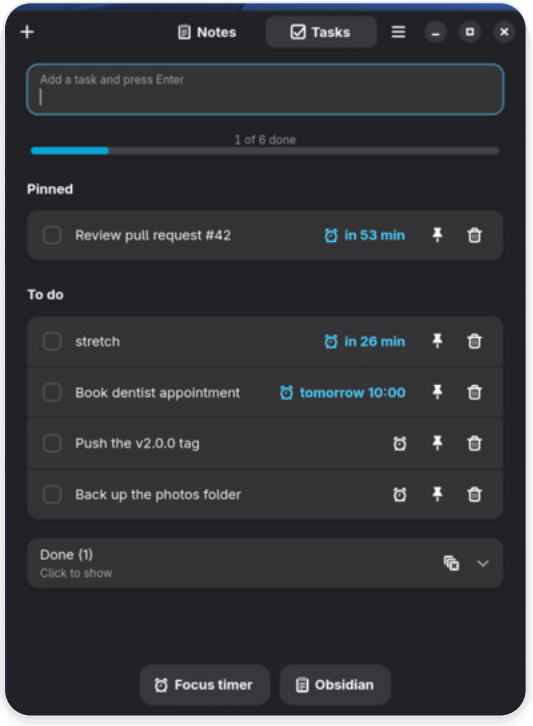


- **Live** reads GNOME directly; a change made anywhere shows up at once
- **Honest status** each shortcut marked working, clashing (and with what), unset or broken
- **Change in a click** press the new keys; add extra keys or remove them
- **Your own commands** + adds a shortcut that runs anything, e.g. a Spotify toggle
- **Undo** reset one shortcut or all of them to the defaults
- **Plain text underneath** config/shortcuts.conf: one line per shortcut, easy to fork

SUPER + SHIFT + N

Companion: notes, tasks and reminders

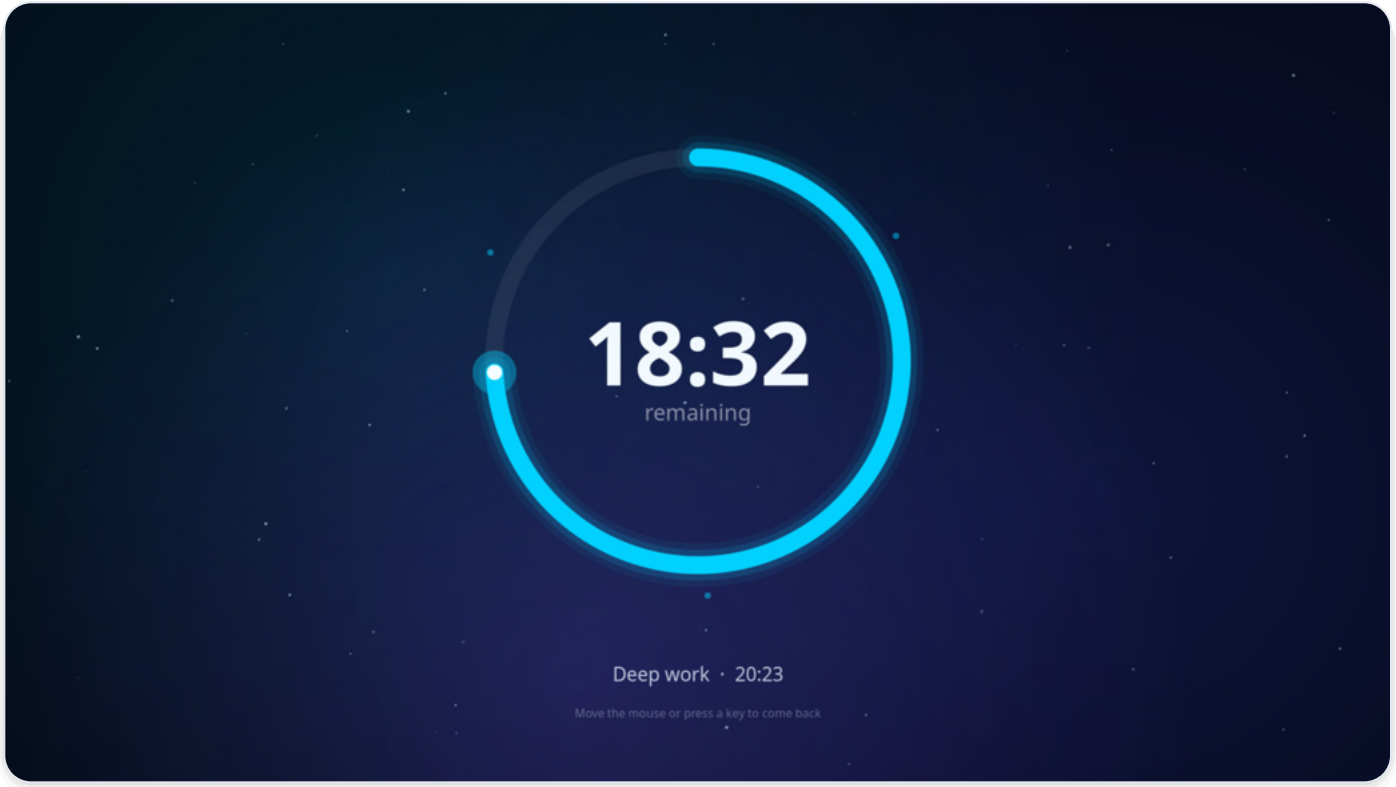




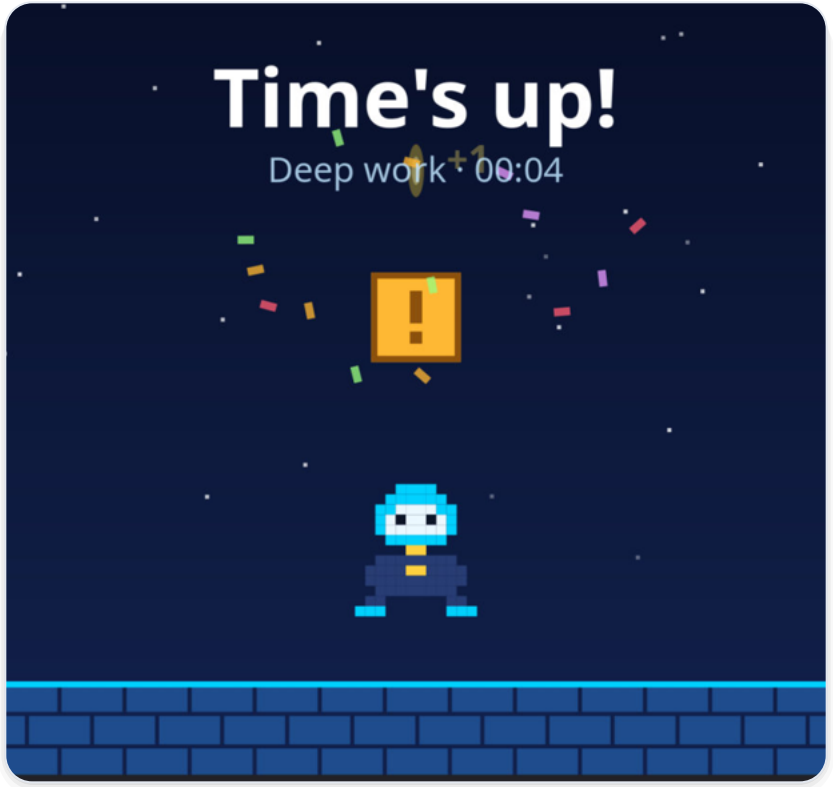
- **Notes that stay out of the way** pin the important ones open on top; the rest fold away
- **Tasks with a progress bar** tick, pin, undo; finished ones collect under Done
- **Reminders** in 10 min, at 18:00, every day or week; they fire even with the app closed, with Snooze
- **Morning brief** one notification with today's tasks and reminders
- **From the terminal** mk note, mk task "pay rent" 18:00, mk list

FOCUS TIMER

Lives on your desktop, not in a window



Step away and the focus screen takes over, like a screensaver

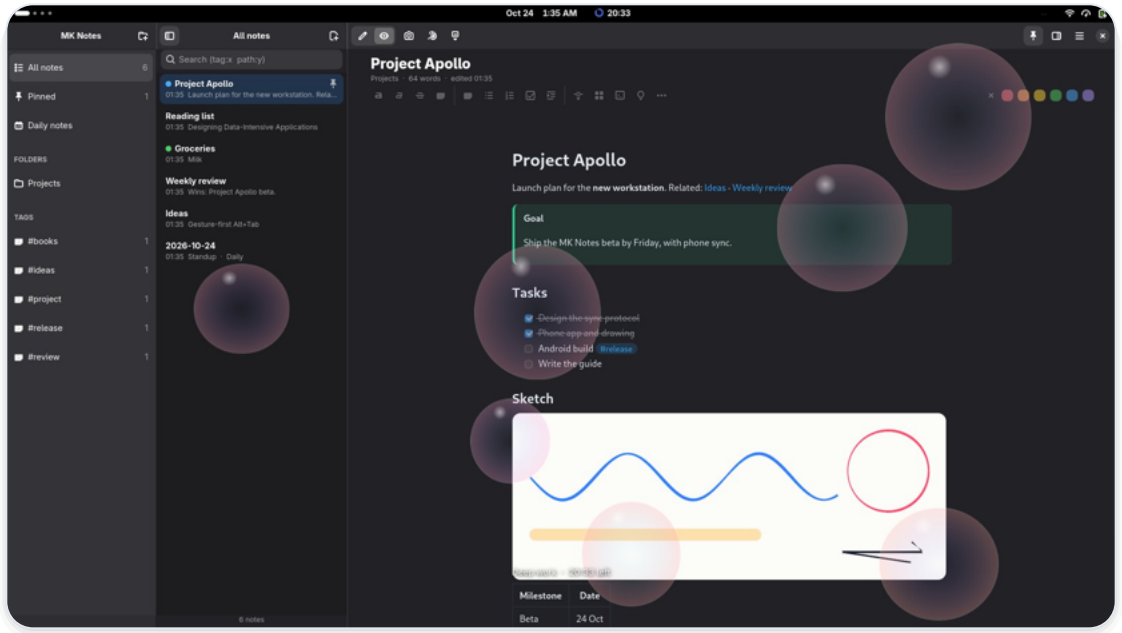


Time's up: robot, coins, fireworks

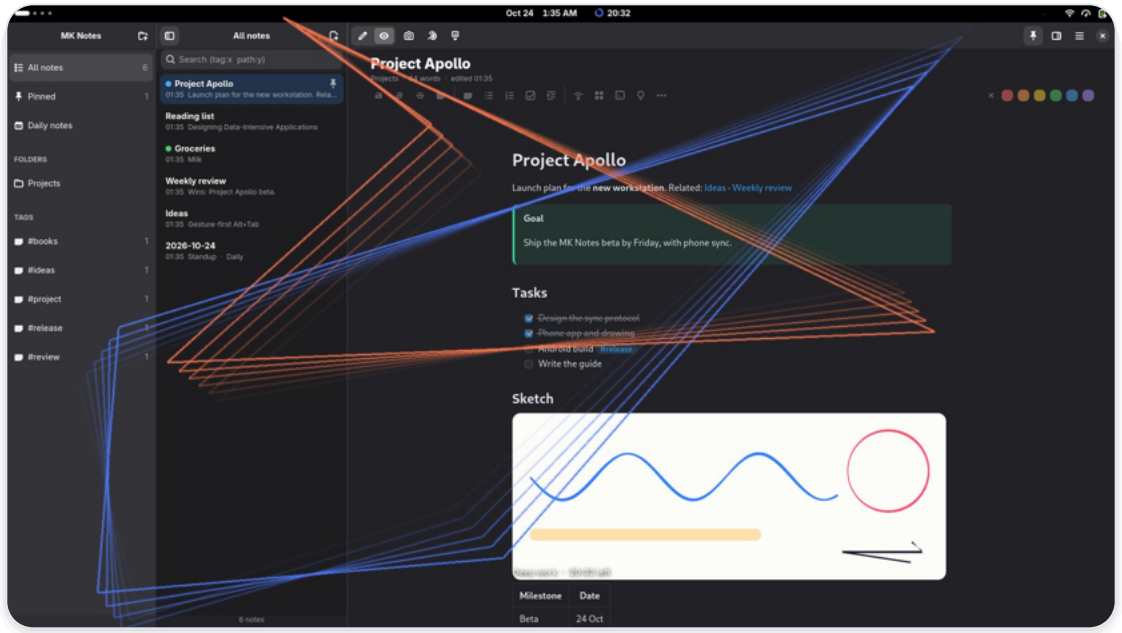
- **Out of the way** the window hides; a small ring and countdown sit in the top bar
- **Calm when you step away** aurora light and the big ring; any key brings you back; never covers a video
- **Focus mode** can silence notifications; a celebration instead of an alarm

STEP AWAY

Screensavers that play over your work



Bubbles: soap bubbles that bounce off each other

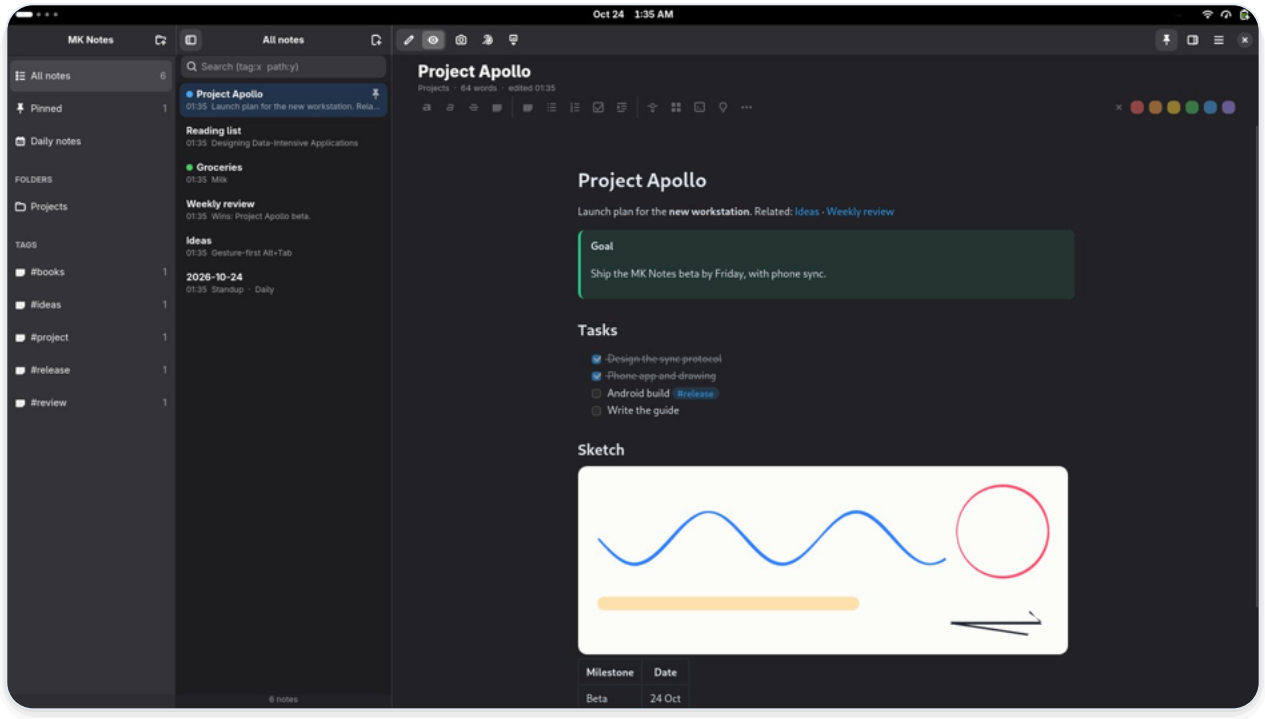


Mystify: glowing shapes with echoes

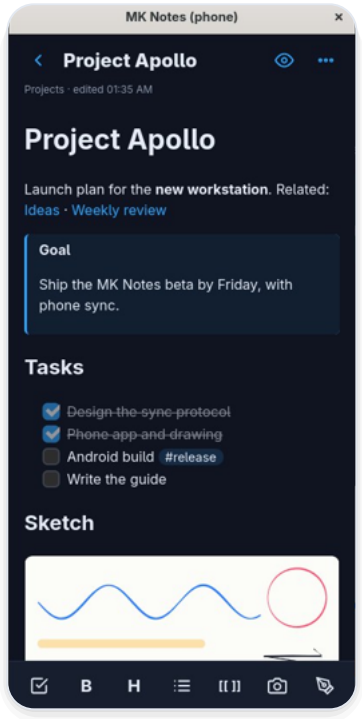
- **No new window** drawn by the top-bar extension right over what you were doing; gone at the first touch
- **Three classics, or a surprise** Bubbles, Mystify, Starfield, or the full-screen Aurora; pick one in the timer
- **Smooth on any machine** a few small moving pieces, not a full-screen canvas: 60 fps even without a GPU

SUPER + N · OBSIDIAN, APPLE NOTES AND SAMSUNG NOTES IN ONE

MK Notes, on laptop and phone



On the laptop: links, callouts, checklists, a drawing

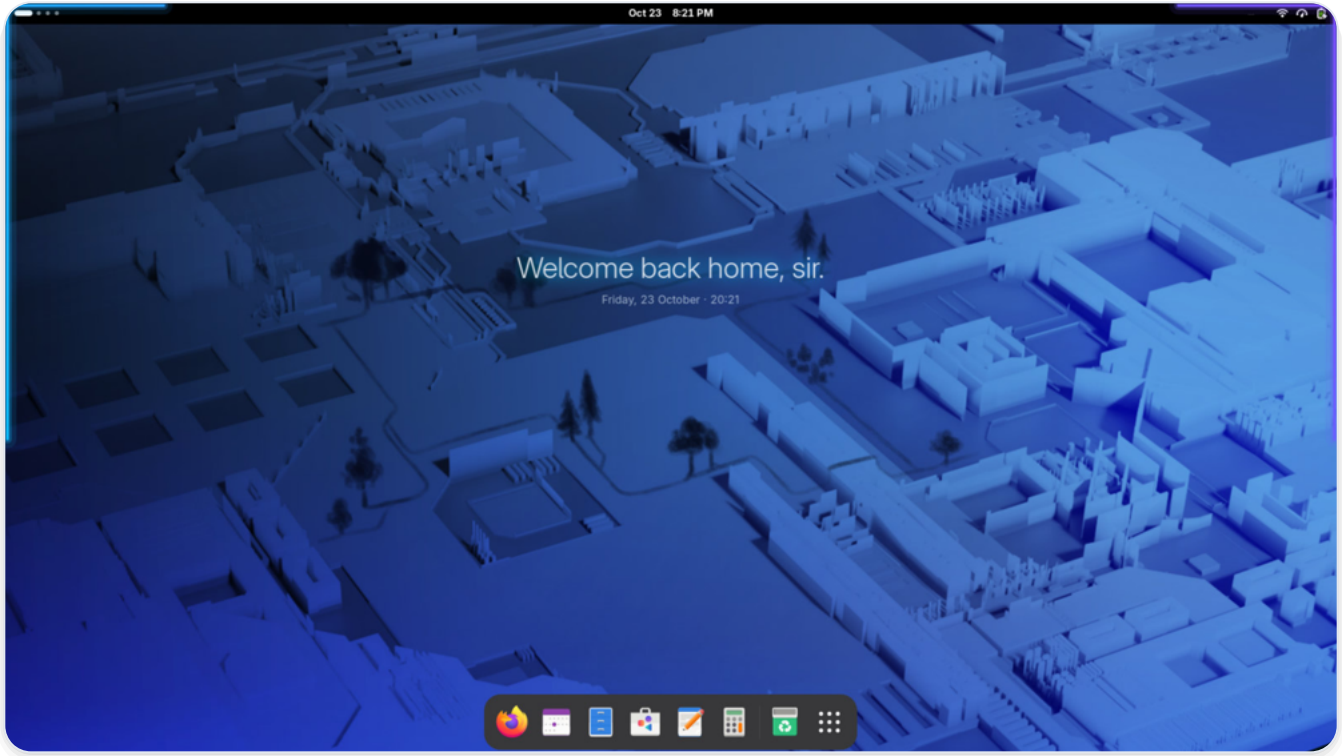


On the phone

- **Your files** a Markdown vault Obsidian opens too; folders, pins, colours, #tags
- **Connected** [[links]], backlinks, outline, graph view, quick switcher
- **Like Apple Notes** paste or capture screenshots, checklists that continue
- **Like Samsung Notes** draw and handwrite with pressure on lined or grid paper
- **Pro features, free** PDF export, publish as a website, version history
- **On your phone** browser or Android app, works offline, syncs over Wi-Fi

AFTER YOU LOG IN

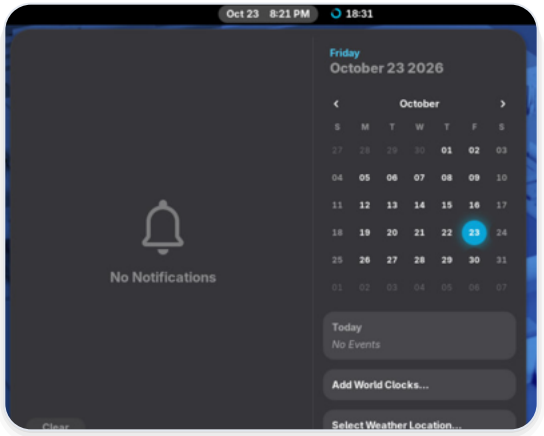
Welcome back home, sir.



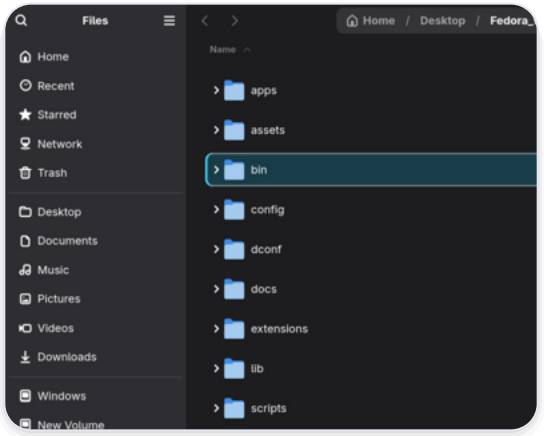
- **Neon edge light** a line races around the screen edges, OnePlus-style, then the greeting fades in
- **Waits for everything** plays once every extension has loaded, so login stays smooth
- **Sir, ma'am or your name** or write your own line; change it in Quick Settings or the Companion
- **A voice like an AI assistant** calm British voice (natural Piper voice optional, no sudo)
- **Your switch** Quick Settings › Welcome light, or mk welcome off

THE LITTLE THINGS

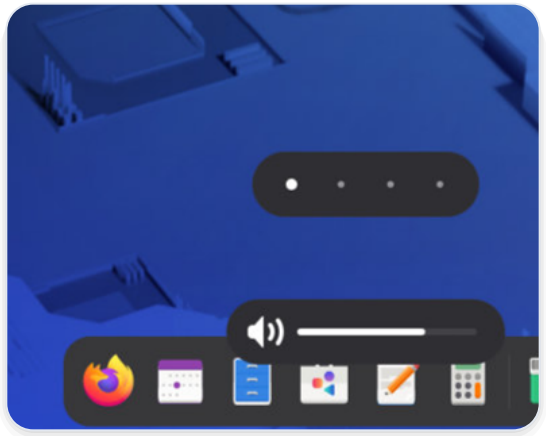
Polished where you look every day



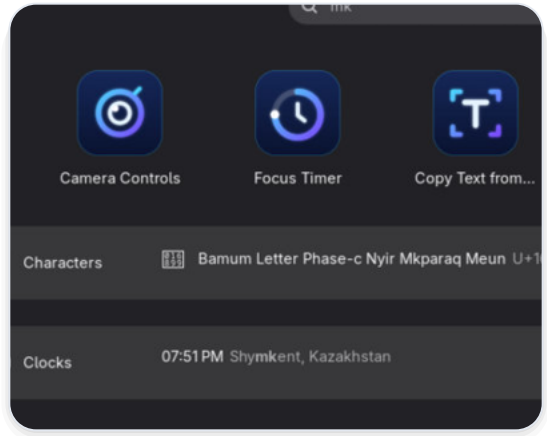
Calendar: glowing today, hover glow



Files: cyan hover and selection



Workspace dots step above volume

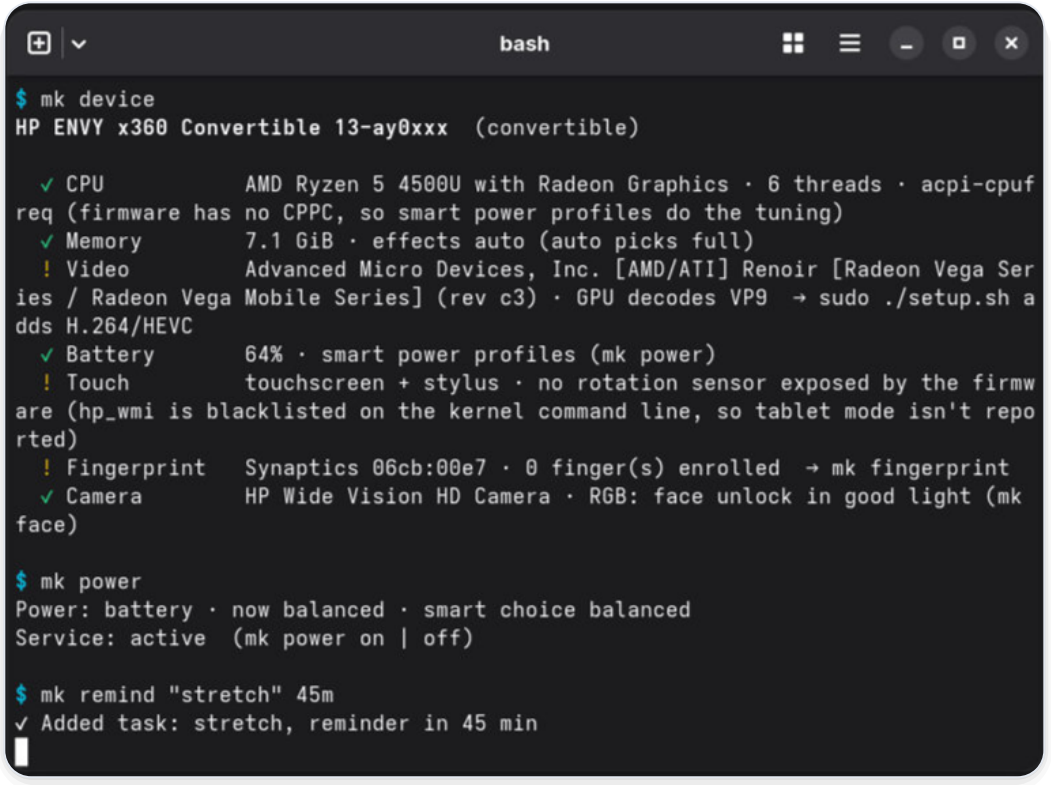


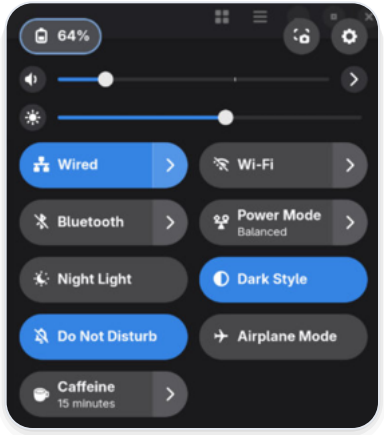
Own icons; swap in yours (mk icon)

- **Speaker tuning** laptop speakers sound thin on Linux without the vendor's Windows DSP; mk sound adds EQ, bass and a limiter
- **Alt+Tab** pops in smoothly; Alt+` switches windows of one app; wobbly windows while dragging
- **Dock** magnification and a soft glow in each app's colour

MADE FOR YOUR HARDWARE

Detects the machine, then tunes for it





- **Fingerprint** reader detected, login and sudo enabled; mk fingerprint to enroll
- **Face unlock** IR or regular webcam, trained for normal, dim and bright light
- **Smart power** performance plugged in, balanced on battery, saver below 25%
- **Video** Intel, AMD or NVIDIA detected; GPU decoding for H.264 and HEVC
- **2-in-1s** rotation sensor service; effects scale to RAM and GPU
- **Smooth login** the login screen uses your display layout: no flicker

mk device on the author's HP ENVY x360 13 (Ryzen 5 4500U) · Quick Settings power mode

OPEN SOURCE

Built to be changed

Rename it	`mk rename "Riya's Desk" RD`	windows, notifications and the top-bar tag follow
Rebind anything	`config/shortcuts.conf`	or click a row in Super+/
Choose the apps	`apps/flatpaks.txt` · `apps/dnf-packages.txt`	mk save captures what you installed
Extensions	`config/enabled-extensions.txt`	settings saved per extension by mk export
Effects and power	`config/effects.conf` · `config/power.conf`	plain key = value files
Keep it current	`mk update`	repo, apps, settings and system, in one go

Documentation: GUIDE for everyday use, CUSTOMIZING for making it yours, ARCHITECTURE and REFERENCE for hacking on it.

GET STARTED

Three commands on a fresh Fedora Workstation

1. `git clone https://github.com/MehulK-techie/fedora-workstation-config` — Download
2. `cd fedora-workstation-config && sudo ./setup.sh` — Install and configure (10–20 min)
3. `mk face  ·  mk fingerprint` — Optional: face and fingerprint login

Then log out and back in. Press **Super + /** to see every shortcut, **Super + Shift + N** for notes and tasks, and run **mk doctor** anytime.